AURORASTAY HOTELS

Refunds and Additional Charges Guide

Refund eligibility, authorization holds, itemized charges, and dispute workflows

Policy code	AS-03
Effective date	January 1, 2026
Review date	January 1, 2027, or sooner if law, systems, or operating conditions change
Owner	Guest Experience and Property Operations
Applies to	AuroraStay managed and franchised properties in the United States, unless a signed contract or local rule requires a different result

How to use this policy
Use the property code, reservation record, and rate rules before giving a guest a final answer. If a property-specific rule is not stated here, contact the property team and record the exception in the reservation notes.

Document map

Navigation	Focus	Primary use
Opening	Scope and quick reference	Answer common guest questions and identify the controlling rule
Core rule	Detailed policy	Apply the standard rule and its exceptions
Lookup	Tables and property matrix	Compare rate, property, charge, or service requirements
Workflow	Workflow and escalation	Resolve edge cases, document decisions, and escalate when needed

Operating note: This is a business policy for guest service teams. It is not a substitute for a property license, emergency procedure, signed group agreement, or advice from qualified counsel. Local and state requirements can be more protective than this baseline.

1. Purpose and refund principles

This guide helps guest service staff explain refunds, releases, credits, and additional charges. The reservation rate terms control eligibility. The payment method and booking channel control how the money moves. Staff must not promise a refund before checking both.

Refunds generally return to the original payment method. A different method may be used only when Finance or a manager approves it and the transaction can be documented. Cash refunds are not the default for card or agency payments.

Three questions before quoting a refund
What was charged? What rule makes it refundable or non-refundable? Who can release or approve the funds? If any answer is unclear, say that the request is under review and give the guest a follow-up channel.

2. Common refund scenarios

Scenario	Baseline outcome	Required verification
Flexible reservation canceled on time	No room charge. If a prepayment was taken, refund the eligible amount after verifying the cancellation timestamp.	Rate plan, local property deadline, booking channel, and payment status.
Flexible reservation canceled late or no-show	One night plus applicable tax may be retained under the baseline rule.	Exact cancellation time, guest notice, property time zone, and any approved exception.
Advance Purchase cancellation	Normally non-refundable. Escalate only with a documented contract, system error, legal requirement, or approved service recovery.	Confirmation terms, payment capture, manager approval, and reason for exception.
Duplicate or incorrect charge	Correct the duplicate or error and refund the excess after reconciling the folio.	Folio, payment ledger, authorization, and whether the booking channel also charged.
Service recovery	Manager may approve a partial refund, credit, or other remedy based on the documented impact.	Complaint facts, remedy offered, approver, amount, and guest acceptance.

3. Additional charges

Charges must be disclosed in the rate, confirmation, property profile, posted notice, or guest agreement before they are applied, except for documented damage or loss assessed under the guest's agreement and applicable law. Staff must provide an itemized folio or receipt on request.

Charge	Typical baseline	When it may apply	Guest explanation
Parking	Property-specific nightly amount	Vehicle uses on-site valet, self parking, or an approved partner garage.	Quote type, nightly amount, tax, and whether in-and-out access is included.
Pet fee	Property-specific per stay or per night	A non-service animal stays under the property's pet policy.	State amount, limit, room restriction, and whether tax applies. Do not charge service animals a pet fee.
Late checkout	Property-specific; may be a flat fee or additional night	Guest receives an approved departure extension.	Confirm the new departure time and exact fee before approval.
Smoking or vaping remediation	Up to $250 baseline, subject to evidence and local law	Credible evidence shows smoking or vaping in a prohibited guest room or indoor area.	Explain the rule, evidence category, charge basis, and dispute channel. Do not charge based on odor alone when facts are unclear.
Lost key or device	Reasonable replacement cost when stated in the property terms	A guest does not return a physical key, parking device, or other property asset.	State the item, replacement basis, and how the guest can return it or dispute the charge.
Damage or missing item	Documented reasonable repair or replacement cost	Inspection supports damage beyond ordinary wear or an item is missing after checkout.	Provide an itemized explanation and dispute path. Do not disclose another guest's information.

The $250 smoking or vaping amount is an internal baseline only. A property may publish a different amount if the guest agreement and applicable law support it. Do not invent a fee that is not in an approved source.

4. Incidentals authorization and release

At arrival, the property may authorize an amount for anticipated incidentals. The authorization can reduce available credit without being a posted charge. When the folio is settled, the property sends a release for the unused amount. The card issuer controls how quickly the pending hold disappears; AuroraStay cannot guarantee a same-day release.

If a guest sees a pending hold after checkout, staff should confirm the final folio, explain that the unused portion was released or is scheduled for release, and advise the guest to contact the card issuer if the pending status persists beyond the issuer's normal timeframe. A pending authorization is not evidence of a second final charge.

5. Property-specific charge examples

Use this table only as a property lookup example. Verify the live profile and the guest's rate confirmation before quoting a charge.

Property	Parking	Pet fee	Breakfast
ASH-ATL Midtown	$28 self parking per night	$75 per stay	$19 adult, $10 child
ASH-BOS Harbor	$65 valet per night	No pets except service animals	Included
ASH-CHI Loop	$42 self parking per night	$50 per night, $150 stay cap	$22 per person
ASH-DEN Union	$35 garage per night	$75 per stay	$18 per person
ASH-MIA Brickell	$55 valet per night	$100 per stay	$24 per person
ASH-SEA Pike	$38 partner garage per night	$75 per stay	Included

6. Refund workflow and dispute handling

Step	Action	Evidence to retain
1	Locate booking channel, rate plan, folio, and payment records.	Confirmation, folio, payment status, cancellation or checkout timestamp.
2	Identify the policy basis for a refund, retained amount, or charge.	Rate terms, property profile, signed agreement, or manager decision.
3	Process the approved transaction in the payment system or route to the channel that collected funds.	Transaction reference and amount. Never store full card data.
4	Tell the guest what was done and when the funds should appear.	Guest communication, promised follow-up date, and escalation owner.
5	Escalate an unresolved dispute to Finance, the manager on duty, or the booking channel.	Issue summary and prior contacts, without sensitive data.

A cardholder who reports an unauthorized charge should be directed to the official contact channel and the card issuer. Staff should not ask the guest to send card numbers, CVV codes, passwords, or identity documents through ordinary email or chat.